



Consumer, Family and Carer Information SOP (Mental Health) Scope

Site	Department, Division or Operational Area	Applicable to
Royal Perth Bentley Group (RPBG)	All Mental Health (MH) Division clinical areas	Multidisciplinary, Clerks

Purpose

The intent of this standard operational procedure (SOP) is to ensure that consumers, carers/personal support persons (PSPs) have access to information that will assist them to understand and exercise their rights and responsibilities during their treatment/care.

The MH Division is committed to ensuring the rights of consumers and their PSPs are respected and all services provide consumers and their PSPs with written information, together with a verbal explanation of their rights and responsibilities in a way that is understandable to them as soon as possible after accessing mental health services and during their care, as required/appropriate.

Acronyms

Acronym	Meaning
EMHS	East Metropolitan Health Service
CoMHWa	Consumers of Mental Health WA
HaDSCO	Health and Disability Services Complaints Office
MHAS	Mental Health Advocacy Service
MHC	Mental Health Commission
MHLC	Mental Health Law Centre
MHT	Mental Health Tribunal
OCP	Office of Chief Psychiatrist WA

It is important that clinicians seek permission from the consumer regarding what can be discussed with the consumer's PSP – e.g. those from the LGBTIQ+ community often have family of choice versus family of blood.

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Procedure Details

Clinicians are to:

- Inform consumers and their PSPs of their rights and responsibilities during their treatment. For further guidance about how to explain consumer's rights refer to the **EMHS Rights of Patients in Mental Health Policy, Rights of Carers and Other Personal Support Persons Policy** and relevant, local procedures/policies
- Support the rights of consumers/PSPs to have their needs understood in a way that is meaningful to them and engage appropriate services that maximise the wellbeing of consumers/PSPs
- Provide consumers with current and accurate information on the care being delivered
- Provide other consumer information/brochures available within RPBG and in the community, as relevant, e.g. community mental health services' consumer brochures/Electroconvulsive Treatment Consumer leaflet
- Medical staff/inpatient staff/Care Coordinator to provide consumers with relevant medication information as per requirements in the Medication Review Policy /obtain via [Choice and Medication website](#)
- Practice within the Mental Health Act (MHA) 2014, the [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\)](#)
- Complete a Datix Clinical Incident Management System (CIMS), e.g. clinical incident related to lack of information/Notifiable Incident Reporting to the OCP, if required
- Ensure the above is documented into progress notes once completed.

The ward/clinic clerk in each relevant area is to ensure:

- Brochure holders in inpatient wards and community clinics are filled with mandatory brochures - see Table 1 below
- "Referral appointment cards" are available to clinical and allied health staff in each inpatient ward to ensure consumers/carers/PSPs are aware of follow up community/outpatient appointments and crisis support numbers.

Compliance Monitoring

Each relevant area will be audited annually for compliance by a consumer representative or staff member in line with NSMHS, ACSQHC NSQHS Standards and the MHA 2014.

Compliance will be monitored as part of the:

- Datix CIMS system process (e.g. clinical incidents relating to lack of information about consumer's rights/medication information/education) /Notifiable Incident Reporting to the OCP, if appropriate
- Compliments/Complaints Management System

The RPBG Mental Health (MH) Division Safety and Quality Unit can be contacted for any issues relating to the ordering of brochures/ refer to the MH Division Hub page for contact details.

RPBG staff to use versions of the State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation (SSCD) that are on PSOLIS/WebPSOLIS (Psychiatric Services On Line Information System) or when they become available on PSOLIS. For documents that are not available on PSOLIS, staff must complete the SSCD documents in paper-based or sanctioned writable PDF format. Refer to the **DoH Triage to Discharge Guidelines** for details of which SSCD documents are available on PSOLIS.

Comprehensive Care documentation will be implemented across RPBG in a staged approach.

Table 1: Mandatory Brochures

Carers Australia WA – Are you caring for a family member or friend?
CoMHWa – General Information
EMHS Freedom of Information
Australian Commission on Safety and Quality in Health Care – My healthcare rights
MHAS: Getting your voice heard – know your rights
MHC: Being referred to a Psychiatrist for an Examination
MHC: Community Treatment Orders
MHC: Information for Personal Support Persons
MHC: Information for Voluntary Patients in Hospital
MHC: Inpatient Treatment Orders
MHC: Nominated Persons – How to make a nomination and what it means.
MHC: Receiving Treatment for a Mental Illness
MHLC: Mental Health Law Centre - General Information
MHT: Are you an involuntary patient?
OCP: Charter of Mental Health Care Principles
RPBG: Feedback Forms – Compliment / Comment / Complaint – ‘Your feedback is important to us’
MHD: Rainbow Tick Feedback Cards

Facilitator

Marika Spaseska, Policy and Legislative Compliance Officer, MH Division, RPBG

Authors / Acknowledgements

We acknowledge the following previous site endorsed work and/or contributors used to compile this document.

Bronwen Larkin, Clinical Systems Support Clerk, Mental Health Safety and Quality Unit, MH Division, RPBG, Sept 2017.

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Review Authors

Bronwen Larkin, Clinical Systems Support Clerk, MH Division, RPBG

Jill Spears, Coordinator of Mental Health Nursing, MH Division, RPBG

Michelle De Silva, Coordinator of Mental Health Nursing, MH Division, RPBG

Hannah Midani, A/ Physical Health Care Clinical Nurse Specialist, MH Division, RPBG

Kemble, Kirstie, A/Community Development Officer, MH Division, RPBG

Related Policies, Practice Standards, Clinical Guidelines

[RPBG Policy Hub](#)

- Mental Health Inpatient Admission Documentation SOP
- Adult & Older Adult Community Mental Health Services Triage to Discharge SOP
- Language Services: Use of Interpreters Policy

[EMHS Policy Hub](#)

- Discharge Communication (Written) Policy
- Rights of Patients in Mental Health Policy
- Rights of Carers and Other Personal Support Persons Policy
- Aboriginal Cultural Group Policy

[Department of Health Policy Hub](#)

- State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation (SSCD)
- Medication Review Policy
- Mental Health Emergency and Follow Up Information on Discharge from Hospital Emergency Departments Policy
- Clinical Incident Management System Policy

Other

- Mental Health Act 2014
- Carers Recognition Act 2004
- WA Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care
- [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\)](#)

Related National Standards

ACSQHC NSQHS Standards 2nd Edition (2021):

Standard 1: Clinical Governance; Standard 2: Partnering with Consumers; Standard 6: Communicating for Safety

National Standards for Mental Health Services (2010): Standard 2: Safety; Standard 6: Consumers; Standard 7: Carers